

NAPCS Unionization Research — State — Charter Sector Overview

Alaska — ALRA (AK) Jurisdiction — June 2026

NAPCS Unionization Research • June 2026 • Template v8.0

Section 1: State Overview

State	Alaska
Labor Board	ALRA (AK) — Alaska Labor Relations Agency — administers Public Employment Relations Act (PERA, AS 23.40.070–23.40.260)
Governing Law	AS 14.03.270(b) (charter school CBA carryover — district CBA applies by default to district-employed charter teachers unless district and bargaining unit jointly agree to waiver). AS 14.03.270(d) (charter may also hire non-district employees outside CBA). AS 23.40 (PERA — public employee labor relations). AS 23.40.090 (bargaining unit determination). All AK charter schools are district-authorized programs. District is employer of record for district-employed teachers.
Federal NLRB Jurisdiction	ALRA (AK) has exclusive jurisdiction. Federal NLRB does not apply.
Right-to-Work	NOT a Right-to-Work State — Alaska has no right-to-work statute. AS 23.40 (PERA) and AS 14.03.270 govern public employee labor relations without RTW restriction. (Alaska is not a right-to-work state. Charter school teachers covered by district CBAs under AS 14.03.270(b) are subject to the full terms of the district NEA-Alaska CBA, which may include union security provisions.)
For-Profit Operator Status	For-profit EMO management contracts permitted under state law
Card-Check Available	NO — PERA (AS 23.40) requires ALRA election for public employee unit certification. Card-check not available for initial certification. However, charter teacher units are not independently certified — they are subsumed under the existing district bargaining unit by statute.
Registry Sweep	COMPLETE — June 2026 — 32 charter schools searched
Research Window	June 2026

Section 2: Charter Sector Landscape

Total charter schools in Alaska: 32 (Alaska DEED Charter School Directory (education.alaska.gov/alaskan_schools/charter/charter-directory), accessed June 2026. 32 open charter schools across 8 school districts.). Unionization census figures reflect confirmed organized schools as of the data currency date.

Category	Schools	% of Total	Notes
Structural Coverage (Dependent)	32	100% of universe	All 32 AK charter schools. Covered by authorizing district NEA-Alaska CBA per AS 14.03.270(b). Waiver verification pending for all schools.
TOTAL	32	100%	

Charter Sector Enrollment

Total Charter Enrollment	7,266 students — 5.6% of state K–12 enrollment (129,876 total K–12 students)
Students in CMO/EMO-Affiliated Charter Schools	0 students (no CMO/EMO networks identified)
Students in Organized Charter Schools	0 students documented
Data Sources	Charter enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 / Charter School Registry v133. Total K–12 state enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 (all public schools). Both figures from the same source and year.

Section 3: Charter Management Organizations & Education Management Organizations

Charter Management Organizations (CMOs) are nonprofit networks. Education Management Organizations (EMOs) are for-profit management companies. Data sourced from Charter School Registry v133. Union penetration reflects confirmed organized schools as of the data currency date.

No charter management organizations identified in Alaska in the Charter School Registry.

Section 4: Legal Framework & Sector Overview

Findings are based on research as of June 2026.

1: Legal & Jurisdictional Framework

AS 14.03.270(b) (charter school CBA carryover — district CBA applies by default to district-employed charter teachers unless district and bargaining unit jointly agree to waiver). AS 14.03.270(d) (charter may also hire non-district employees outside CBA). AS 23.40 (PERA — public employee labor relations). AS 23.40.090 (bargaining unit determination). All AK charter schools are district-authorized programs. District is employer of record for district-employed teachers. Alaska is not a right-to-work state (Alaska has no right-to-work statute. AS 23.40 (PERA) and AS 14.03.270 govern public employee labor relations without RTW restriction.). ALRA (AK) has exclusive jurisdiction. Federal NLRB does not apply to charter schools in Alaska. Secret ballot NLRB election is the required organizing pathway. Card-check is not available.

2: Charter Sector Structure

Alaska operates 32 open-enrollment charter schools, enrolling approximately 7,266 students. No multi-campus charter networks are identified in the Charter School Registry for Alaska. Approximately 32 schools operate independently with no CMO or EMO affiliation.

Section 5: Media Coverage & Public Stakeholder Positions

Press Coverage

No press coverage of charter-school-specific union organizing activity in Alaska was identified. District-level bargaining coverage is extensive (Anchorage Daily News, Alaska Public Media) but does not specifically address charter school CBA coverage under AS 14.03.270(b).

Stakeholder Communications

NEA-Alaska (neaalaska.org) covers all district bargaining in Alaska. Charter school CBA coverage under AS 14.03.270(b) is not specifically addressed in NEA-Alaska public communications. The Anchorage Education Association communications cover ASD-wide bargaining including charter school employees. No charter school employer communications regarding union organizing or CBA waiver were identified.

Authorizer & State Agency Positions

Alaska DEED charter school FAQ (education.alaska.gov) states: "Teachers in a charter school are subject to the district's negotiated agreement unless the district and the teacher's bargaining unit agree otherwise." This is the authoritative public statement of the AS 14.03.270(b) framework.

Coalition & Advocacy Positions

No AK charter sector coalition has published positions on the AS 14.03.270(b) CBA coverage framework.

Section 6: Contract & CBA Access Registry

ALRA (AK) public contracts portal. Direct PDF links may require a records request for full text.

School / Network	Union	CBA Status & Term	Contract Access
ASD Charter Schools (8 schools — see SCHOOLS array)	Anchorage Education Association (AEA) / NEA-Alaska / NEA	CONFIRMED 2026-2029 (3-year CBA ratified February 2026)	N/A
FNSBSD Charter Schools (5 schools — see SCHOOLS array)	Fairbanks Education Association (FEA) / NEA-Alaska / NEA	CONFIRMED In active negotiations as of April 2026	N/A
JSD Charter School (1 school — Juneau Community Charter School)	Juneau Education Association (JEA) / NEA-Alaska / NEA	CONFIRMED Active — current period to be confirmed	N/A
KPBSD Charter Schools (5 schools — see SCHOOLS array)	Kenai Peninsula Education Association (KPEA) / NEA-Alaska / NEA	CONFIRMED Active — 2021-2024 CBA extended one year to June 30, 2025; 2025-26 negotiations in progress	N/A
KGBSD Charter Schools (2 schools — see SCHOOLS array)	Ketchikan Education Association (KEA) / NEA-Alaska / NEA	CONFIRMED Active — current period to be confirmed	N/A
LKSD Charter School (1 school — Ayaprun Elitnaurvik)	Lower Kuskokwim Education Association (LKEA) / NEA-Alaska / NEA	CONFIRMED Active — current period to be confirmed	N/A
LYSD Charter School (1 school — Hooper Bay Charter School)	Lower Yukon Teachers Association (LYTA) / NEA-Alaska / NEA	CONFIRMED Active — current period to be confirmed	N/A
MSBSD Charter Schools (8 schools — see SCHOOLS array)	Matanuska-Susitna Education Association (MSEA) / NEA-Alaska / NEA	CONFIRMED Active — current period to be confirmed	N/A
NCSD Charter School (1 school — Anvil City Science Academy)	Nome Education Association / NEA-Alaska / NEA	CONFIRMED Active — current period to be confirmed	N/A